The meeting was emotional. As soon as Ratan opened the door to Prem's cabin, Mahalingam recalls his pleasantly surprised son saying, 'Ratan uncle, how come you are here, I thought you were in Australia?' Ratan replied, 'No, Prem, I came to see you.'

Mahalingam's wife, Saroj, was equally surprised to see Ratan. She asked him the reason. Ratan replied, 'I just came, made a detour just to see Prem because I knew if I went to Sydney [without seeing him], I would never see him again.'

Mahalingam says emotionally, 'That is the stuff Ratan is made of.' Ratan hid his detour from JRD. 'JRD never knew about this. He thought he [Ratan] was in Sydney, but all the time he' was in Jamshedpur and he later flew to Sydney from Calcutta.

Ratan's empathy and compassion distinguish him from other industrialists. His staff has benefited from it and looks up to Ratan, seeing in him qualities that are unique and extraordinary. The friendly and polite manner in which Ratan treats his man Friday, Rajen Shaw, is worthy of a study. Rajen, born in Calcutta and originally hailing from a remote village in Bihar, speaks proudly of Ratan's magnanimity, how he is a mentor and a friend to him and so considerate and caring about his children. As someone who had worked in the Indo-Suez Bank in Saudi Arabia as a chef and butler before he joined Ratan, Rajen has seen many bosses and says that no one can even compare to Ratan.

Ratan's personal peon, Gopal Singh, who hails from Uttarakhand but has made Mumbai his home, says that his dream is to serve his benefactor until the end. 'He is the only God I know,' he says.

Ratan is wholeheartedly egalitarian. He has often said that India suffers from an 'environment that is inherently unequal'. He believes that providing equal opportunities promotes competition and a quest for happiness, unfettered by cronyism and privilege. He comments: 'I'd say my greatest desire as an Indian is to be proud of my country because it is an equal-opportunity nation.'

Prioritizing Workers' Welfare and Community Development

All the Tata Group chairmen have adhered to Jamsetji's ethos of treating workers with dignity and respect. But Ratan took this principle to a different level. Besides dealing with employees as equals, he took decisions